

DAVID J. BRAUN

FULL STACK & PLATFORM ENGINEER | CLOUD | DEVOPS | AI-ENABLED SYSTEMS

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Full-stack and platform engineer with 6+ years delivering enterprise applications, cloud infrastructure, CI/CD automation, security remediation, and AI-enabled systems across Target, GE Aerospace, Securian Financial, U.S. Bank, and consulting engagements. Strongest in AWS, GitHub Actions, Java/Kotlin, TypeScript/React, Python, containerized delivery, and translating complex platform needs into reliable production systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Application & AI Systems: Java, Kotlin, Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Spring Boot, FastAPI, REST APIs, Kafka, Redis, LLM/RAG workflows

Cloud & Platform: AWS (EKS, ECR, EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, Route 53, Lightsail), Kubernetes, kubectl, Helm, OpenShift, Docker, Nginx; GCP/Firebase; Azure DevOps/Functions

Delivery, IaC & Quality: GitHub Actions (primary), CircleCI, Jenkins, Ansible, CloudFormation, Terraform (prior use), CodeQL, SonarCloud, SAST/DAST, Playwright, OpenAI Codex, Claude Code

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Principal Software Engineer | People's Connection LLC - Remote

Jun 2020 - Present

- Architect and deliver client-facing full-stack and platform systems using React/Next.js/Astro, Node.js/FastAPI, AWS, Docker, Redis, GitHub Actions, and AI-assisted engineering workflows.
- Operate the production VIFG nonprofit platform on AWS Lightsail; manage ECR-backed Docker releases, Route 53 DNS, SSL/TLS, Nginx, accessibility gates, dependency audits, and automated deployments.
- Built and delivered a QR-based wedding media platform primarily through AWS CloudFormation and S3, enabling live guest photo/video uploads and Google Photos integration; use Codex and Claude Code for human-reviewed implementation, testing, debugging, and refactoring.

Systems Engineer | U.S. Bank - Remote

Nov 2024 - Feb 2025

- Tested, validated, and troubleshooted REST API integrations with Postman, improving transaction accuracy, request/response reliability, and downstream data consistency.
- Coordinated with stakeholders, external vendors, and cross-functional teams to resolve enterprise integration issues and document repeatable support workflows.

Infrastructure Engineer | Securian Financial - Remote

Nov 2022 - Mar 2024

- Authored and maintained Ansible playbooks for AWS EC2 provisioning, server configuration, and application deployment, improving speed, repeatability, and reliability.
- Built Java/Spring Boot services and supported AWS EKS/Kubernetes delivery using kubectl, Helm, deployment configuration, and workload-capacity settings to improve stability under demand.
- Managed applications across EC2, S3, and RDS and built Python automation that reduced manual processing by 40%; supported GitHub, SonarQube, and SauceLabs.

Cybersecurity Engineer | General Electric Aviation - Remote

Oct 2021 - Oct 2022

- Remediated vulnerabilities in Java and React applications running in OpenShift environments, editing deployment YAML and inspecting pods while applying SAST/DAST findings and secure coding practices.
- Designed and documented REST APIs with Swagger/OpenAPI, secured endpoints with OAuth2/JWT, and supported secure AWS EC2, S3, and Lambda integrations across distributed teams.

Software Engineer | Target - Minneapolis, MN

Jun 2019 - Jun 2020

- Built React applications and Kotlin microservices; supported EKS/Kubernetes delivery using kubectl, Helm, CircleCI configuration, and Ansible-based workflows for internal platforms.
- Diagnosed issues across 30+ repositories and upgraded or refactored 50+ repositories, improving stability, functionality, build consistency, and maintainability.
- Led cross-functional work across globally distributed Agile teams, translating platform problems into coordinated implementation, modernization, and delivery efforts.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

M.S. Artificial Intelligence - University of St. Thomas, MN | Expected Dec 2026 | Relevant: Cloud Computing, MLOps, Data Lakes & Advanced Analytics, Conversational AI

B.S. Computer Science, Mathematics & Physics - Augsburg University, Minneapolis, MN | May 2020 | **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2024)**